

In-Class Discussion

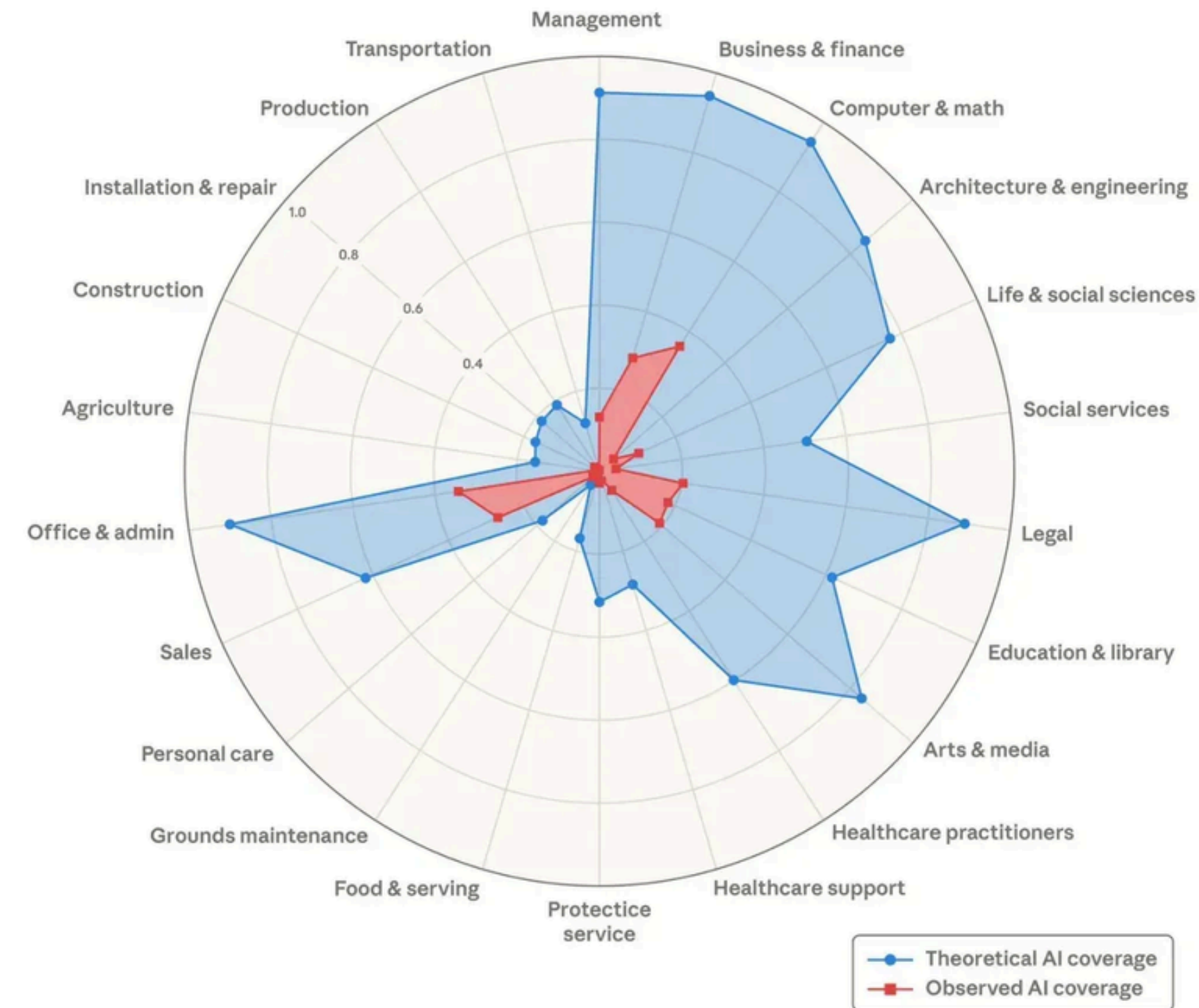
EN 601.124: The Ethics of Artificial Intelligence and Automation

Department of Computer Science, April 15th 2026



In-Class Discussion

Theoretical capability and observed usage by occupational category



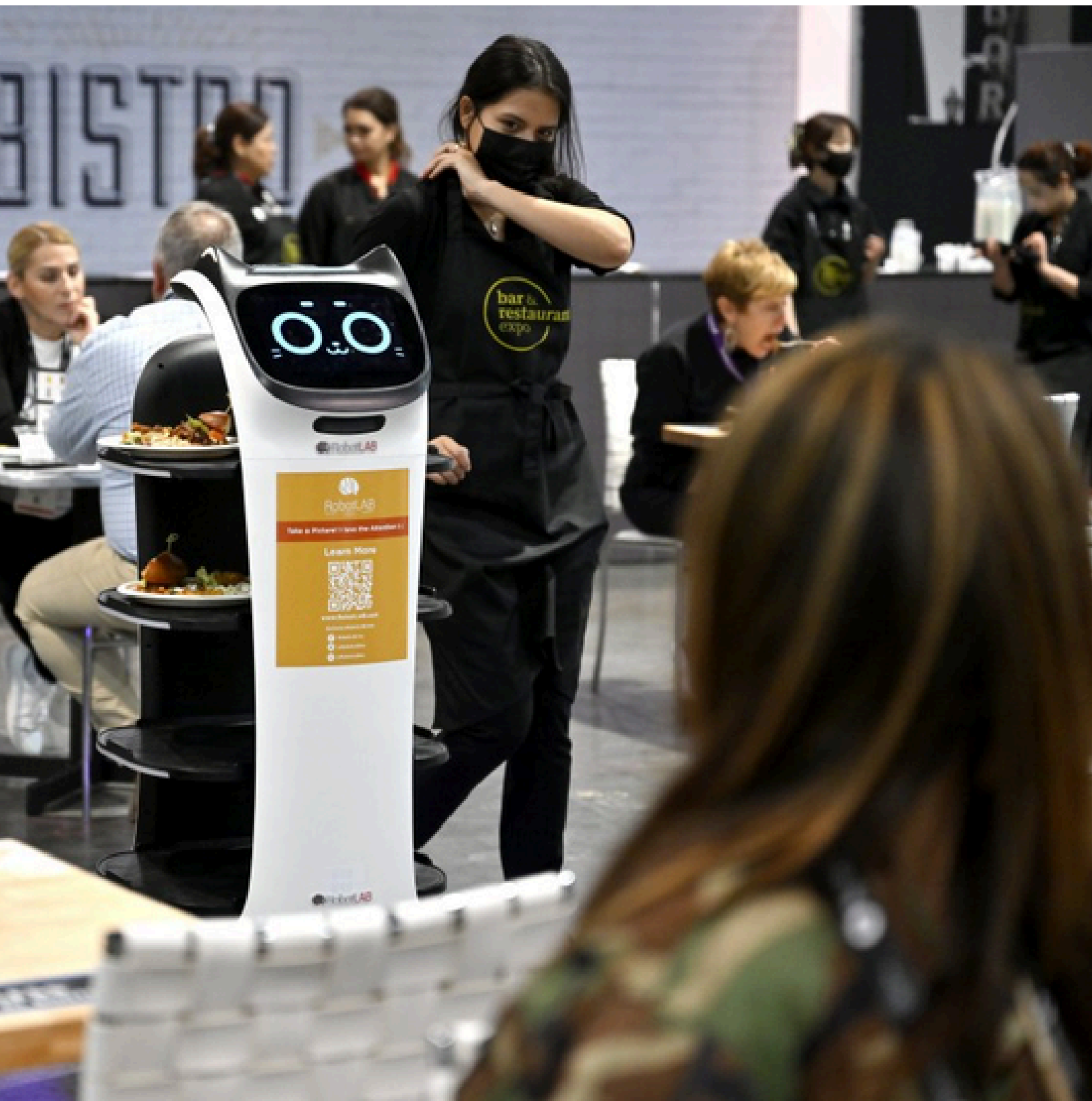
AI models already possess the theoretical ability to automate most jobs, but legal constraints and corporate adoption rates have created a significant gap between potential and reality

Questions:

- How can we make full usage of AI? What is “full”?
- How can we preserve human decision-making capability and skillset? Pick one example and describe a sociotechnical solution to preserving or increasing human ability.
 - For instance, some radiologists have seen a decrease in ability following incorporation of AI.



In-Class Discussion



Make an argument grounded within one or more of the papers:

If we were to either have only AI employees or only humans performing a specific domain job, what would it be?

For instance, underwater welding should either have only “AI” or only “humans”. Nurses should have only “AI” or only “humans”.

Describe why you would prefer it referencing notions of:

- Interpersonnel interactions
- Quality of life
- Creativity
- Trust
- Repercussions



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AI use in workforce has benefits such as increased productivity and new discoveries. We read papers outlining risks: decreased perceptions of those who use AI, or narrowing creativity.

Which of these risks are you most concerned about? What could be the ways to mitigate?



In-Class Discussion

AI Policy Template

[Company Name]

This policy outlines how AI tools should be used across the company. It helps employees understand what's allowed, what's not, and how to use AI responsibly and securely in their work.

1. Purpose and scope of the policy

This policy outlines how artificial intelligence (AI) tools may be used within [Company Name]. It applies to all employees, contractors, and third-party vendors who use AI tools in the course of their work with or for the company. The goal is to support responsible, secure, and ethical use of AI while minimizing risks.

2. Definitions of AI tools and technologies

For clarity, here are some definitions we'll use throughout this policy:

- **Artificial intelligence (AI):** Software that mimics human intelligence to perform tasks like analyzing data, making decisions, or generating content.
- **Generative AI:** A type of AI that can produce new content, such as text, images, or code (e.g., ChatGPT, Midjourney, GitHub Copilot).
- **Machine learning:** Algorithms that improve through experience and data exposure, often used behind the scenes in AI tools.

These tools include, but aren't limited to, public or enterprise versions of language models, image generators, automation platforms, and internal AI applications.

3. Authorized use guidelines

Employees are encouraged to explore AI tools for efficiency and creativity—but with limits:

✓ Acceptable uses:

- Summarizing meeting notes or internal reports
- Drafting first versions of internal communications
- Automating repetitive tasks (e.g., formatting, tagging).

✗ Unacceptable uses:

- Generating client-facing content without human review or approval
- Using AI to replace human judgment in decision-making processes
- Uploading or training tools on sensitive or proprietary data.

If in doubt, check with your team lead or IT contact before using any AI tool for a new purpose.

4. Data privacy and security considerations

Publicly available AI tools should never be used to process sensitive information. Such information includes but is not limited to:

- Customer data

In Class Activity:

Imagine your ideal job in 10 years.

- What is the job (specific job title, specific example employer)?
- What do you do day to day?
 - List at least 5 tasks you
- Are you managing other people?
 - If so, list at least 5 tasks they do

Take 5 minutes to think on your own and write down your answers (in a word doc or google doc or similar).

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In Class Activity:

Now outline an AI use policy for your job

- What AI use is encouraged, what is discouraged,
- List **5 specific issues** in your AI use policy, sourcing concrete concepts from the class).

In-Class Discussion



In Class Activity II:

Search for openings for that dream job today.

- Find at least 3 URLs

Question:

- How might that job be changed with 10 years of AI development in terms of
 - day to day tasks done by them
 - what tasks are done by humans vs by AI.

Rewrite the job opening from the future

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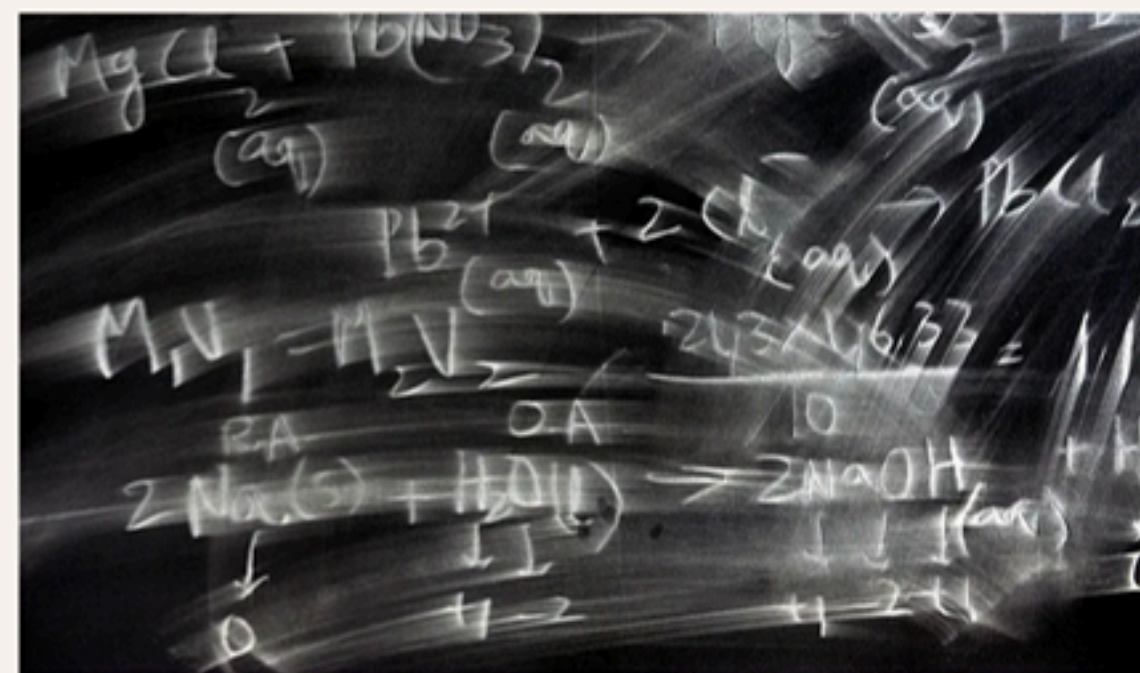


In Class Activity II:

Post your notes on Piazza.

In-Class Discussion

The College Kids Who Can't Do Basic Math



ONE OUT OF EVERY EIGHT NEW STUDENTS AT UC SAN DIEGO HAVE MATH SKILLS BELOW THE MIDDLE-SCHOOL LEVEL.
(BILL O'LEARY/THE WASHINGTON POST VIA GETTY IMAGES)

More than 10 percent of new students at a prestigious California university are taking math that covers what they should have learned as far back as elementary school.

By **Tanner Nau**

11.11.25 — Education

Education

These are deep investigations—from kindergarten to college—into school choice, the misalloc

FOLLOW TOPIC

AI has shown a remarkable benefit to professional coders in the paper by Peng et al.

Question 1: Given evidence of math deficiency from recent news articles,

- How will AI assisted coding impact long-term ability of novice developers and entrepreneurs?
- Will there ever be true skill or a consistent reliance?
- How does this relate to a business model and monetary incentives that companies hold?

Question 2: What are some *scary* thoughts about novice programmers developing public-facing applications impacting real people?

- What does the future of safety look like in this field?
- How can we enforce it?

